

Task 1: Presentation

Title: "The Qianlong Emperor: Curating the Chinese Imperial Tradition"

1. Who wrote the paper?

- Dr. Evelyn S. Rawski, a prominent historian specializing in the Qing dynasty.

2. What is the paper about?

- The paper analyzes how the Manchu Emperor Qianlong strategically used Han Chinese cultural traditions—art, poetry, historiography, and public rituals—to portray himself as the ultimate universal ruler and legitimate heir to the Chinese imperial throne, including the legacy of the Han dynasty.

3. When was the paper published?

- 1998

4. Where was the paper published?

- In the book "The Cambridge History of China, Vol. 9, Part 1: The Ch'ing Empire to 1800."

5. Why did the author write the paper?

- To challenge the view of the Qing as a period of decline and to show how Qianlong actively and successfully synthesized Manchu and Han identities to strengthen his rule and expand the empire, directly engaging with the political models established in the Han era.

Task 2

Part 1: Getting Your Gemini API Key

Step 1: Understand API Key Security (CRITICAL)

- Read Thoroughly: Before you get your key, read the “Keep your API key secure” section from the official Gemini API documentation. Your API key is like a password; anyone who has it can use your quota and potentially charge you.

- Link: <https://ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/api-key>
- Key Practices:
 - Never commit your API key directly to code that you upload to public repositories like GitHub.
 - Do not share your key with others.
 - Do not store it in a Word document or other unsecure formats.

Step 2: Generate Your API Key

1. Go to Google AI Studio: <https://aistudio.google.com/app/apikey>
2. Log in with your Google account if prompted.
3. Click on the “+ Create API Key” button in the top-right corner.
4. A pop-up will appear. Click “Create API key in new project”.
5. Your new API key will be displayed. Copy it immediately.

Step 3: Store Your API Key Securely

Option A: Store in a Secure .txt File (Basic)

- Open a text editor like Notepad (Windows) or TextEdit (Mac – in “Plain Text” mode).
- Paste your API key into the file.
- Save the file with a descriptive name like `gemini_api_key.txt` in a secure folder on your computer (e.g., your user directory). Do not save it to your Desktop or Downloads where it might be accidentally shared.

Option B: Set as an Environment Variable (Recommended)

This is the professional way to handle secrets, as it keeps them out of your code.

· On Windows:

1. Press Win + R, type `sysdm.cpl`, and press Enter.
2. Go to the “Advanced” tab and click “Environment Variables...”
3. Under “User variables,” click “New...”
4. For “Variable name,” enter `GEMINI_API_KEY`.
5. For “Variable value,” paste your API key.
6. Click “OK” to close all dialogs.

· On macOS / Linux:

1. Open your terminal.
2. Open your shell configuration file (e.g., `~/.zshrc` for macOS or `~/.bashrc` for Linux) in a text editor.
3. Add the following line to the file:

```
```bash
Export GEMINI_API_KEY='YOUR_ACTUAL_API_KEY_HERE'
```
```
4. Save the file and run `source ~/.zshrc` (or `~/.bashrc`) to load the change.
5. You can verify it's set by typing `echo $GEMINI_API_KEY` in the terminal; it should print your key.

Part 2: Downloading and Installing Anaconda

Anaconda is a distribution of Python that comes with many essential data science and machine learning packages pre-installed, along with a powerful package manager (conda).

1. Go to the Download Page: Navigate to the official Anaconda website: <https://www.anaconda.com/download>
2. Select Your Installer: Choose the installer for your operating system (Windows, macOS, or Linux). It is recommended to select the 64-Bit Graphical Installer for Python 3.x.
3. Run the Installer:
 - Windows: Double-click the downloaded .exe file and follow the setup instructions. It is generally safe to use the default settings.
 - macOS: Double-click the downloaded .pkg file and follow the prompts.
 - Linux: Run the bash script you downloaded in your terminal.

```
```bash
Bash ~/Downloads/Anaconda3-2023.09-Linux-x86_64.sh
```
```

(The filename might be slightly different). Follow the prompts on the screen.

4. Verify Installation: Open a new terminal (or Command Prompt on Windows) and type `conda list`. If Anaconda is installed correctly, it will display a list of installed packages.

Summary of Deliverables for You:

- A Gemini API Key has been created and copied.
- The API Key has been securely stored either in a .txt file or as an environment variable named `GEMINI_API_KEY`.
- Anaconda has been successfully downloaded and installed on your computer.
- You can verify the installation by running `conda list` in your terminal/command prompt.

TASK 3

English Summary

The Second Section Preamble, "The Twenty-Six Malignant Gates," sets a ominous tone, depicting a mother warning her daughter of the unseen dangers that lurk beyond the safety of their home. The mother speaks of a book that lists all the bad things that can happen to a child once they venture past the twenty-six gates of their neighborhood. When the curious daughter demands to know what these specific dangers are, the mother refuses to list them, asserting that the daughter simply needs to obey without question. This preamble establishes the core theme for the following chapters: the profound, often frightening, and sometimes uncommunicated fears that mothers hold for their daughters, and the protective, authoritarian instincts that can create a wall between them.

In Chapter 5, "Rules of the Game," Waverly Jong narrates her rise as a childhood chess prodigy. She learns the "art of invisible strength" from her mother, Lindo, who teaches her that the secret to winning lies in controlling one's emotions and keeping one's strategies hidden. Waverly's incredible success in national tournaments becomes a point of immense pride for her mother, who proudly displays her daughter as a trophy. However, this pride becomes a point of conflict. Waverly grows to resent her mother's hovering presence and constant commentary, feeling like she is just another one of her mother's possessions. The climax occurs in a public argument where Waverly's defiant words create an invisible, permanent wall between them, leaving her mother's influence feeling both empowering and suffocating.

Chapter 6, "The Voice from the Wall," shifts to Lena St. Clair's perspective, exploring a household filled with silent suffering. Lena, the daughter of an Irish-American father and a Chinese mother, Ying-Ying, lives in a home haunted by her mother's profound depression and cultural dislocation. Ying-Ying, who believes she has a "yin face" that can see other people's tragedies, has retreated into a ghost-like existence. Lena, in turn, has developed her own anxieties, listening to the violent fights of her neighbors and internalizing the unhappiness around her. The chapter details the chilling, emotionless "balance sheet" she and her husband keep for shared expenses, mirroring the emotional distance in her own home. Both chapters ultimately portray daughters who are deeply shaped by their mothers' traumas and worldviews, struggling to find their own voices amidst the echoes of their mothers' fears and unspoken pasts.

Resumen en Español

El preámbulo de la Segunda Sección, "Las Veintiséis Puertas Malignas", establece un tono ominoso, describiendo a una madre que advierte a su hija sobre los peligros invisibles que acechan más allá de la seguridad de su hogar. La madre habla de un libro que enumera todas las cosas malas que le pueden suceder a un niño una vez que se aventura más allá de las veintiséis puertas de su vecindario. Cuando la curiosa hija exige saber cuáles son esos peligros específicos, la madre se niega a enumerarlos, afirmando que la hija simplemente necesita obedecer sin cuestionar. Este preámbulo establece el tema central de los capítulos siguientes: los profundos, y a menudo aterradores, temores que las madres albergan por sus hijas, y los instintos protectores y autoritarios que pueden crear un muro entre ellas.

En el Capítulo 5, "Reglas del Juego", Waverly Jong narra su ascenso como una niña prodigio del ajedrez. Aprende el "arte de la fuerza invisible" de su madre, Lindo, quien le enseña que el secreto para ganar radica en controlar las emociones y mantener las estrategias ocultas. El increíble éxito de Waverly en torneos nacionales se convierte en un motivo de inmenso orgullo para su madre, quien la exhibe con orgullo como un trofeo. Sin embargo, este orgullo se convierte en un punto de conflicto. Waverly llega a resentir la presencia constante y los comentarios de su madre, sintiendo que es solo una de sus posesiones. El clímax ocurre en una discusión pública donde las palabras desafiantes de Waverly crean un muro invisible y permanente entre ellas, haciendo que la influencia de su madre se sienta a la vez empoderadora y asfixiante.

El Capítulo 6, "La Voz desde el Muro", cambia a la perspectiva de Lena St. Clair, explorando un hogar lleno de sufrimiento silencioso. Lena, hija de un padre irlandés-estadounidense y una madre china, Ying-Ying, vive en una casa atormentada por la profunda depresión y la desubicación cultural de su madre. Ying-Ying, quien cree que tiene un "rostro yin" que puede ver las tragedias de otras personas, se ha refugiado en una existencia fantasmal.

Lena, a su vez, ha desarrollado sus propias ansiedades, escuchando las violentas peleas de sus vecinos e internalizando la infelicidad que la rodea. El capítulo detalla la escalofriante y fría "hoja de balance" que ella y su marido llevan para los gastos compartidos, reflejando la distancia emocional en su propio hogar. Ambos capítulos retratan finalmente a hijas profundamente moldeadas por los traumas y las visiones del mundo de sus madres, que luchan por encontrar su propia voz entre los ecos de los miedos y los pasados no dichos de sus madres.